

# NOT TODAY

THE 60-DAY PLAN • NO SCREENS IN THE HOUSE • ONE DECISION A DAY

This is a **contract**, not a **vow**. Vows are made to yourself at midnight and broken at midnight. Contracts are made to another person in daylight and enforced by architecture. For 20 years the war was hourly — a thousand decisions in the dark. This plan replaces all of them with **one decision a day, made at the door, when you are strong**:

“IS THIS A SCREEN? THEN IT DOES NOT CROSS THIS DOOR.”

## THE 3 LAWS

- 1 • **NO VOWS. ONLY TODAY.** No “never again,” no streak worship. A slip is data, not death. Only quitting is failure. Every morning: *not today*.
- 2 • **NEVER MISS TWICE.** One slip is a data point. Two in a row is a collapse. The gap between slip #1 and slip #2 is where this war is won.
- 3 • **NO SECRECY.** One human knows everything, every day. The nightly check-in is not optional — not after a good day, not after a slip. *Especially* after a slip.

## THE CONTRACT

1. For **60 days**, no screen device — phone, laptop, tablet, anything with a browser — crosses the door of my house. Day 1 is the first full day after signing.
2. **A slip is not a reset.** If a device crosses the door, I remove it, I text my witness that night, and the clock keeps running. Only quitting is failure.
3. The only devices allowed inside: a **dumb phone** (calls + texts only), a speaker/radio, an alarm clock. That is the complete list.
4. My smartphone and laptop live at the office — locker or desk — **not in my car, not in my house.**
5. Every night, one line to my witness: “Day \_\_, *clean*” or “*Slipped, back on it.*”
6. On Day 61, the re-entry rules (page 3) become permanent house law.

SIGNED (me) — in daylight, not at midnight

DATE

WITNESSED BY — holds my keys, gets one line every night

DATE

WITNESS’S JOB: hold the phone passcodes/PIN. Receive one line every night. If the check-in stops for 48 hours, you call. That is the entire job.

## DEVICE PROTOCOL

### SMARTPHONE — the office vault

- Lives at the office. Wakes there, sleeps there. **Never rides home, not even in the car.**
- **9:00 am trade check:** on the **laptop** (kite.zerodha.com — full trading). Phone supplies the OTP for 60 seconds, in daylight. Your danger window is 9:30 pm–2 am. They never meet.
- Armor it anyway: *iPhone* → Screen Time → Content & Privacy Restrictions → Web Content → **Allowed Websites Only** (broker/bank/work only) → Screen Time passcode → **witness holds it.** *Android* → Private DNS (nextdns.io, block “Porn”+“Dating”) → delete all browsers → parental PIN → witness holds it.
- Delete the pipelines: any app whose feed ever led you in.

### DUMB PHONE — the only house phone

- ₹1,200–1,500 Nokia-style. Calls, SMS, torch, radio. **No browser. No video. No capability.**
- Carries the nightly check-in, family calls, emergencies. You are never unreachable.
- Charges in the kitchen. Never the bedroom.
- **Apple Watch:** by day only (cellular, standalone); off at 9:30 pm, kitchen. Never a tether for the phone.

### BOOKINGS & PAYMENTS — before 9 pm

- Swiggy, UPI, bills, bookings: all done **in daylight, outside the house**. If it can’t be done before 9 pm, it doesn’t happen that day.
- Dinner is cooked, ordered, or carried in before the door closes behind you.
- You are a man who plans his evening in the afternoon. That habit is part of the cure.

## THE EVENING TIMETABLE – EVERY DAY, NO EXCEPTIONS

| TIME        | ACTION                                                                           |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Office ends | <b>Straight to the gym.</b> Never home first. The route passes through it.       |
| 7:30–8:30   | Workout, hard enough to breathe. Medicine, not fitness. Non-negotiable.          |
| 8:30–9:15   | Cook. Eat slowly. Shower. No screens exist here.                                 |
| 9:15–9:30   | <b>Check-in text to witness</b> — from the dumb phone. “Day __, clean.”          |
| 9:30–10:15  | Read a physical book. Stretch. Write. Walk around the block. Offline, all of it. |
| 10:30       | <b>Lights out.</b> The alarm clock wakes you.                                    |

**THE WHOLE NIGHT IS DECIDED BEFORE YOU GET HOME.** You don’t resist urges at midnight — you made them impossible at 6 pm when the phone stayed at the office. The dangerous window (9:30 pm–2 am) now contains nothing that can hurt you.

## THE URGE DRILL – MEMORIZE THIS

Urges are waves: they rise, peak in **15–30 minutes**, and **crash on their own** — whether you act or not. Don’t fight them. Watch them pass.

1. **NAME IT:** “This is the urge. Dopamine asking. It peaks in minutes and dies. I don’t have to obey it.”
2. **SURF IT:** don’t fight, don’t obey — *observe*. Locate it in the body. Breathe through the peak. Suppression makes it stronger; watching kills it.
3. **MOVE:** 20 pushups. Cold water on the face. Walk out of the room. Motion ends the wave.
4. **FIRE THE IF-THEN:** the pre-written handler below. No decision. No negotiation.

**Pre-Written IF-THEN Plans (tape on desk, fridge, car dashboard)**

IF urge at the desk → THEN close everything, 20 pushups, 5-minute walk outside.  
IF urge after 9 pm → THEN keys in hand, 10-minute drive, call your witness from the car.  
IF urge from stress or boredom → THEN call or walk — never touch a screen.  
IF hand reaches for any screen after 9 pm → THEN stand up and leave the room. Instantly.  
IF weekend night alone and restless → THEN gym, or a long drive with an audiobook. Never the couch.  
**IF lying in bed awake and the mind starts spinning → THEN stand up NOW. Cold water, 20 pushups, book until sleepy. Bed = sleep only.**

## THE SLIP PROTOCOL – PRE-WRITTEN, BECAUSE SLIPS WILL COME

A slip is a **data point**, not a verdict. The relapse only begins if you add shame, secrecy, or a second slip on top of it.

1. **NO OATH. NO DRAMA.** The 60-day clock keeps running. Only quitting is failure.
2. **3-LINE LOG:** time, mood, what happened 10 minutes before. Data, not confession.
3. **PHYSICALLY LEAVE.** Shower. Walk. Move the body out of the scene.
4. **BACK ON THE RUN THE SAME DAY.**
5. **TELL THE WITNESS TONIGHT:** “Slipped. Back on it.”
6. **NEVER MISS TWICE.** The first slip is a lesson. The second is the relapse. Keep them apart.

## THE 60-DAY TERRAIN – WHAT TO EXPECT

| DAYS                       | WHAT’S HAPPENING                                                                     | YOUR JOB                                                                                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1–14</b> Withdrawal     | Urges peak. Restlessness, racing mind, trouble sleeping. Boredom is loud.            | Follow the timetable mechanically. Win each day.                                          |
| <b>15–30</b> The Flatline  | Numbness, low mood, “this isn’t working.”                                            | <b>This is recovery, not failure.</b> Fill the void: workouts, sunlight, cooking, humans. |
| <b>31–45</b> Recalibration | Urges weaken. Real things — food, workouts, people — feel good again. Sleep deepens. | 3–4 hard workouts/week. One in-person human contact/week, minimum.                        |
| <b>46–60</b> The Shift     | You stop being “a man quitting” and become “a man who doesn’t.”                      | Keep the architecture. The structure did this — not your mood.                            |

## THE FUEL LINE – YOU LIVE ALONE, SO BUILD HUMANS IN

- **Daily:** one phone call, 10 minutes minimum, to a real human. Scheduled. A voice is the antidote to a screen.
- **Weekly:** one in-person meeting — dinner, chai, a drive. Non-negotiable.
- **One group:** gym class, running club, badminton, trek group. You don’t need friends — you need **scheduled humans**.

## DAY 61 – THE STAGED RE-ENTRY (DECIDED BEFORE DAY 1)

### PERMANENT HOUSE LAWS – FROM DAY 61 ONWARD

1. **Days 61–90:** phone may come home — **only inside the timed lockbox** (Kitchen Safe: timer, no override). Laptop only for daylight work, at a table. Never the bedroom.
2. **Forever:** no screen ever crosses into the bedroom. That room is the scene of 20 years of losses. It stays sealed.
3. **Forever:** after 9:30 pm the house has no screens. Not a 60-day experiment — the permanent design of a sane life.
4. **Forever:** the nightly check-in continues. The dumb phone stays. A man who needs no witness is a man in danger.

### SHOPPING LIST – COMPLETE BEFORE DAY 1

- ☐ Dumb phone (₹1,200–1,500)
- ☐ Alarm clock
- ☐ 5 physical books (one gripping page-turner)
- ☐ Notebook + pen
- ☐ Speaker/radio
- ☐ Kitchen Safe lockbox — order now, it's for Day 61 (Amazon.in: "Kitchen Safe Time Locking Container")
- ☐ Printed workout sheet
- ☐ This document on the fridge

### DAY 0 CHECKLIST – DO ALL OF THIS BEFORE DAY 1

- ☐ Sign the contract with your witness (page 1). They keep a copy.
- ☐ Armor the smartphone and leave it at the office.
- ☐ Set up the dumb phone. Give the number to family + witness.
- ☐ Stock the house: books, notebook, food to cook, speaker, workout sheet.
- ☐ Tape the timetable + IF-THEN list to the fridge.
- ☐ Send the first check-in: *"Day 0. Contract signed. Starting tomorrow."*
- ☐ Tonight: last night with screens in the house. Notice how it feels. It's the last time.

### THE PENAL CODE – PRE-AGREED, PAID IN DISTANCE, NEVER IN SHAME

**NO BASE – STARTS FROM ZERO.** Every hour connected is priced; every violation climbs from there.

- 1 • Device crosses the door (any connection) → **50 km cycle/hour (day) · 100 km/hour (night)**, rounded up, min 1 hour.
- 2 • Device used inside the house → **200 km cycle**.
- 3 • Device in bedroom / after 9:30 → **300 km cycle**.
- 4 • Faked exception / lying / guard off / WiFi re-enabled → **400 km cycle** + no exceptions for 30 days.
- 5 • Never-miss-twice broken (2 slips in 7 days) → **500 km cycle** that week + voice call every night ×7.
- 6 • Blocked-site session (DNS) → **20 km cycle per 15-min burst**.
- 7 • Unpaid after 48h → **doubles**. No proof by deadline → doubles again.

Paid by cycle, walk, run or swim — outdoors, verified. 2 km cycle = 1 km walk/run · 1 km swim = 4. Proof to your witness. **Never punished with: self-hate, a reset clock, new oaths, or public posting.**

**EXCEPTIONS (forced only, never chosen):** illness · emergency · lockdown · festival closure · critical work. Protocol: witness told, device in bag, daylight-only, ends when the force ends. Faked exception = lying = **400 km cycle**.

### THE CLOSING TRUTH – READ THIS WHEN IT GETS HARD

For 20 years you fought with oaths, and oaths demand strength at midnight — alone, in the dark, against a brain trained for two decades to want this. You were not weak. **You were outmatched by the arena. This plan changes the arena.** One decision a day, in daylight, at a door: *is this a screen? Then it stays outside.* You can win one decision.

The first week will feel rough — restless, bored, sure this is pointless. That feeling is 20 years of wiring coming loose. It passes. When a slip comes: no oath, three lines, out of the room, back the same day, one honest text. **Never miss twice.**

“I do not need to win 60 days.  
I need to win today.  
Tomorrow, I will win tomorrow.  
NOT TODAY.”